Darshak Patel

Senior / Lead DevOps Engineer | Cloud Engineer

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Professional Summary

Senior DevOps Engineer with over 12 years of experience designing, implementing, and optimizing cloud-native infrastructure, CI/CD pipelines, and containerized environments. Expertise across GCP, AWS, and Azure, Terraform, Kubernetes, and Docker Swarm, with a proven track record of achieving 99.99% uptime, reducing operational costs by up to 30%, and enhancing deployment efficiency through automation. Recognized for leading complex migrations and fostering cross-functional collaboration to deliver scalable, secure systems for gaming and enterprise applications. Adept at adapting to new technologies and mentoring teams to drive DevOps best practices.

Core Skills

Cloud Technologies:	Google Cloud Platform, Amazon Web Services, MS Azure
Container Orchestration:	Kubernetes (EKS, GKE), Docker Swarm, ECS, Google Cloud Run
CI/CD & Automation:	GitHub Actions, Buildkite, Jenkins, GitLab CI, Helm
Infrastructure as a Code:	Terraform, CloudFormation, Ansible, Packer
Programming & Scripting:	Bash, Python, PowerShell, TypeScript, Go
Observability:	Prometheus, Grafana, Datadog, New Relic, OpenTelemetry,
Security & Networking:	IAM, Workload Identity Federation (OIDC), PAM, pfSense, KMS, Vault, Secret Manager
Database Administration:	PostgreSQL (Cloud SQL, Aurora), RDS, Redis, QuestDB
Incident Management:	PagerDuty, OpsGenie, Rootly, SLO/SLA, On-call Operations, RCA
Tools & Platforms:	Jira, Notion, Linear, SonarQube

Career Highlight

🏆 Part of the Improbable DevOps team recognized by Google Cloud's 2022 DevOps Awards for building a cloud-native CI/CD-as-a-Service platform that reduced build costs by 70%, improved scalability sixfold, and achieved over 99.99% build success rate.

Academic Qualification

B.E. in Computer Engineering – Vishwakarma Government Engineering College (GTU), 2013

Certification and Training

- Red Hat Certified Engineer (RHCE)
- Red Hat Certified System Administrator (RHCSA)
- Red Hat OpenStack Cloud Technology Training

Professional Experience

IMPROBABLE WORLDS LTD. (Including Zeuz GmbH & Improbable MV Ltd.)
Duration: **03/2019 – Present**
Role: DevOps Engineer

*(**Zeuz GmbH** acquired by Improbable Worlds Ltd. in 2020; currently contributing under Improbable MV Ltd.)*

Key Responsibilities & Achievements:

- Recognized as part of the award-winning DevOps team honored by Google Cloud's 2022 DevOps Awards for building a scalable, cost-efficient, cloud-native CI/CD platform.
- Developed and operated multi-region cloud infrastructure using Terraform, Docker Swarm, and Kubernetes, achieving 99.99% uptime for large-scale game-server deployments.
- Migrated CI/CD pipelines from Buildkite to GitHub Actions, improving deployment reliability, cutting operational cost by about 20%, and speeding up delivery.
- Ran services on Cloud Run, Compute Engine MIGs, and AWS EC2 Auto Scaling Groups, plus Kubernetes and Docker Swarm game-server clusters (EKS, GKE) across bare-metal (Gcore, G-Portal, Hetzner) and cloud, behind global load balancers, Cloud CDN, and Cloud Armor.
- Provisioned multi-region GKE clusters in GCP from scratch with Terraform (node pools, networking, and Cloud Armor). Handled Kubernetes version and node-pool upgrades, and managed Helm chart releases, updates, and rollouts for platform services.
- Operated Cloud SQL and Amazon RDS/Aurora for PostgreSQL (IAM auth, PITR, read replicas, and pg_partman partitioning), Memorystore/Redis, and QuestDB. Ran schema migrations with golang-migrate through the Cloud SQL Auth Proxy.
- Optimized and modernized backend services (for example, moving from ExpressJS to Fastify) and tuned application performance through load testing, database indexing, and Cloud Run configuration.
- Built and maintained a CI/CD-as-a-Service platform that supported hundreds of daily builds and reduced cost per build by over 60%, as highlighted in Google Cloud's DevOps case study.
- Set up observability with Prometheus and Google Managed Prometheus (via OpenTelemetry), Grafana, Grafana Cloud, Loki, and Datadog, with alerts routed through Rootly, improving incident detection and system reliability.
- Managed on-call operations and incident response for live game-server environments, holding SLA/SLO targets and cutting downtime through root cause analysis.
- Collaborated cross-functionally with global engineering teams to align architecture, improve deployment efficiency, and drive performance optimization initiatives.

CIGNEX DATAMATICS PVT. LTD. **01/2017 to 11/2018**
Role: DevOps Consultant

Key Responsibilities & Achievements:

- Automated build and deployment pipelines using Jenkins, reducing human error and speeding up releases.
- Developed and maintained Puppet manifests and modules to deploy, configure, and manage servers at scale.
- Engineered secure and cost-effective infrastructure tailored to client requirements on both on-premises and cloud platforms.
- Rolled out Java-based Liferay frameworks with Apache and Varnish Cache to improve web application performance.
- Created and maintained Ansible playbooks to automate provisioning, patching, and system configuration tasks.
- Implemented Nagios-based monitoring to proactively track and manage infrastructure performance and resource utilization.
- Collaborated closely with development and QA teams to ensure reliable CI/CD workflows and faster deployment cycles.

IBIBO GROUP PVT. LTD. **06/2016 to 01/2017**

Role: DevOps Engineer

Key Responsibilities & Achievements:

- Migrated application from Bare-metal hosted servers to AWS hosted servers for scalability.
- Wrote ansible modules for automation of application deployments.
- Design and implement platforms for monitoring, log processing, metrics collection and data visualizations.
- Setup rapid testing Development environments using Vagrant & Docker.
- Configured application and Infrastructure monitoring and alerting using NewRelic.
- Interact with other team members including Development, Quality Assurance, Consulting and Product Management.
- Working closely with Development team to understand infrastructure requirement to deliver and troubleshoot any application related issues.

I-LINK INFOSOFT PVT. LTD. **10/2014 to 05/2016**

Role: Trainee lead - System Administrator

Key Responsibilities & Achievements:

- Designed and managed IT infrastructure across German and US datacenters, ensuring security, reliability, and compliance.
- Implemented DevOps automation using Jenkins and Ansible for streamlined infrastructure management and deployment.
- Deployed and maintained virtualization platforms (Citrix Xen, Hyper-V, VMware ESXi) to optimize server utilization.
- Configured secure environments following Department of Defense (DoD) security guidelines, including centralized authentication (FreeIPA, Active Directory) and SSL/TLS hardening.
- Administered HP physical servers via iLO/IPMI and managed network infrastructure (HP ProCurve, pfSense with CARP HAProxy).
- Set up and managed web and application servers (LAMP, Node.js, Elasticsearch, Couchbase) along with ELK Stack for centralized logging.
- Established site-to-site IPsec VPN tunnels and ensured high availability for critical services across global environments.

Zaptech Solutions & Kalp System Pvt. Ltd. 10/2013 – 10/2014

***Role**: Linux System Administrator / Network & System Engineer*

Key Responsibilities and Achievements:

- Installed, configured, and maintained in-house Linux and Windows servers (Apache, FTP, Samba, and related services) for internal and client operations.
- Deployed and managed VMware ESXi environments hosting multiple virtual servers for development and production workloads.
- Configured and administered private GitLab, mail, proxy, and chat servers, ensuring secure and reliable internal communications.
- Designed and managed local and wide-area networks, including VLANs, DHCP/static IP schemes, routers, and Cisco switches.
- Configured and maintained SonicWALL firewalls with content filtering, VPN tunnels, and security policies for data protection.
- Performed database administration tasks including MySQL backups, restores, and optimization for application environments.
- Provided server and network support for hosted environments (WHM/cPanel) and ensured stable connectivity and uptime across infrastructure.